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阅读 C

气候变化正在改变世界的“气味景观”

说明文 · 环境与文化 · 全文 340 词 · 逐句精读

1 **Smells** are **all around** us.

气味无处不在。

smell n. 气味

all around 到处；在周围

² What we know as a **scent** (气味) is a **collection** of natural or **artificial** **airborne** **chemicals** **released** from objects.

我们所说的气味，是从物体中释放出来的、飘散在空气中的天然或人造化学物质的集合。

scent n. 气味；香味

collection n. 集合；一组（事物）

artificial adj. 人造的

airborne adj. 空气中的

chemical n. 化学物质

release v. 释放

³ But smell is often overlooked and undervalued.

但嗅觉常常被忽视，也被低估。

overlook v. 忽视

undervalue v. 低估

⁴ So, as **climate change** and **biodiversity** loss **threaten** natural scents, many people may not even **notice**.

因此，当气候变化和生物多样性丧失威胁到自然界的气味时，许多人甚至可能察觉不到。

climate change 气候变化

biodiversity n. 生物多样性

threaten v. 威胁

notice v. 注意到

5 Whether or not we pay attention to the world's “scentscape”, heat and pollution are causing it to shift.

无论我们是否留意世界的“气味景观”，高温和污染都在使它发生变化。

whether or not 无论是否

pay attention to 注意

scentscape n. 气味景观

pollution n. 污染

shift v. 改变；变化

⁶ As temperatures rise, man-made substances release more scent molecules (分子), and biodiversity loss due to climate change threatens the plants that scent the environment.

随着气温升高，人造物质会释放更多的气味分子；而气候变化导致的生物多样性丧失，也威胁着那些为环境增添气味的植物。

temperature n. 温度

man-made adj. 人造的

substance n. 物质

molecule n. 分子

due to 由于

environment n. 环境

⁷ “If you go to a **forest**, you have a **given** environment and temperature.

“如果你走进一片森林，那里有特定的环境和温度。

forest n. 森林

given adj. 特定的；既定的

⁸ If that temperature goes a little bit higher, the **profile** of the chemical **components** in the air changes,” **explains** John Smith, a chemical engineer — temperature can **affect** the number of smell-carrying gas **particles** (粒子) released from substances.

如果温度再升高一点，空气中化学成分的构成就会改变，” 化学工程师约翰·史密斯解释说，这是因为温度会影响物质释放出的、携带气味的气体粒子的数量。

profile n. 构成；概况

component n. 成分

explain v. 解释

affect v. 影响

particle n. 粒子

⁹ “And therefore, the perception of how the forest smells changes.”

“因此，人们对这片森林气味的感知也会改变。”

therefore adv. 因此

perception n. 感知；感觉

¹⁰ That **effect** **extends** **beyond** forests.

这种影响不仅限于森林。

effect n. 影响

extend v. 延伸；扩展

beyond prep. 超出……范围

¹¹ Snow — already threatened by a **warming climate** — **absorbs** different chemicals from the **atmosphere** as temperatures rise, which changes its cold-clean scent.

雪本身已经受到气候变暖的威胁；随着气温升高，雪会从大气中吸收不同的化学物质，这会改变它那种清冷干净的气味。

warming climate 气候变暖

absorb v. 吸收

atmosphere n. 大气

¹² Warmer **conditions** can **intensify** smells, leading the snow to smell more **unpleasant** and **potentially** **gather** more **pollutants**.

更温暖的环境会使气味变得更浓，让雪的气味更难闻，还可能让雪聚集更多的污染物。

condition n. 环境；条件

intensify v. 加强；加剧

unpleasant adj. 令人不快的

potentially adv. 潜在地；可能

gather v. 聚集

pollutant n. 污染物

¹³ Climate change is also quickening the loss of biodiversity, threatening to erase certain smells entirely.

气候变化还在加速生物多样性的丧失，可能会让某些气味彻底消失。

quicken v. 加快

erase v. 抹去

certain adj. 某些

entirely adv. 完全地

¹⁴ When plants disappear, their scents become more difficult to produce.

植物消失了，它们的气味也就更难产生了。

disappear v. 消失

produce v. 产生

15 Some scents are linked to cultural heritage.

有些气味与文化遗产相关。

be linked to 与……相关

cultural adj. 文化的

heritage n. 遗产

¹⁶ A **recent** study **reported** that **native communities** in Peru noticed a change in the smell of the Amazon River due to **industrial** pollution.

最近的一项研究报告称，秘鲁的原住民社区注意到，由于工业污染，亚马孙河的气味发生了变化。

recent adj. 最近的

report v. 报告

native adj. 本土的；原住民的

community n. 社区；群体

industrial adj. 工业的

17 Over **generations**, communities became **desensitised** to **increasingly** smelly rivers, a sign of broader **ecosystem** **degradation**.

一代又一代人下来，这些社区对越来越难闻的河流变得麻木了——河流越来越难闻，是生态系统更大范围退化的一个迹象。

generation n. 一代人

desensitise v. 使麻木；使不敏感

increasingly adv. 越来越

ecosystem n. 生态系统

degradation n. 退化；恶化

18 At the same time, in some Amazonian belief systems, declining water quality and the unpleasant smells will lead to the dispersal (消散) of the river's spiritual beings.

与此同时，在亚马孙地区的一些信仰体系中，水质下降和难闻的气味会导致河中的神灵消散。

at the same time 与此同时

belief n. 信仰

decline v. 下降

lead to 导致

dispersal n. 消散；分散

spiritual adj. 精神的；神灵的

¹⁹ The **damage** to the scentscape could **result in** **harm** to both health and spiritual **practice**.

对气味景观的破坏，可能会同时危害人们的健康和精神信仰活动。

damage n. 破坏

result in 导致

harm n. 伤害

practice n. （宗教、信仰等的）惯常活动；习俗

20 Even though we have other valuable things endangered by climate change, like food access, there is also an element of cultural identity, cultural survival, and history.

尽管还有其他宝贵的东西受到气候变化的威胁，比如获取食物的途径，但气味中也包含着文化认同、文化存续和历史的元素。

even though 尽管

valuable adj. 宝贵的

endanger v. 危及

access n. 获得（的途径）

element n. 元素；成分

identity n. 身份；认同

survival n. 存续；幸存

²¹ If we don't **look at** it, we lose all the **richness** behind it.

如果我们不去关注它，就会失去它背后的全部丰富内涵。

look at 关注；审视

richness n. 丰富